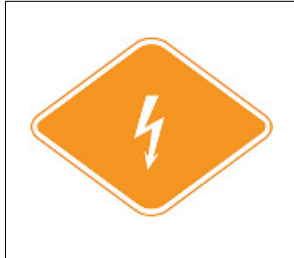




## INFORMATION FOR FIRST AND SECOND RESPONDERS



### EMERGENCY RESPONSE GUIDE



**TESLA**  
**MODEL 3 2024+**  
**ELECTRIC**



VERSION: 003

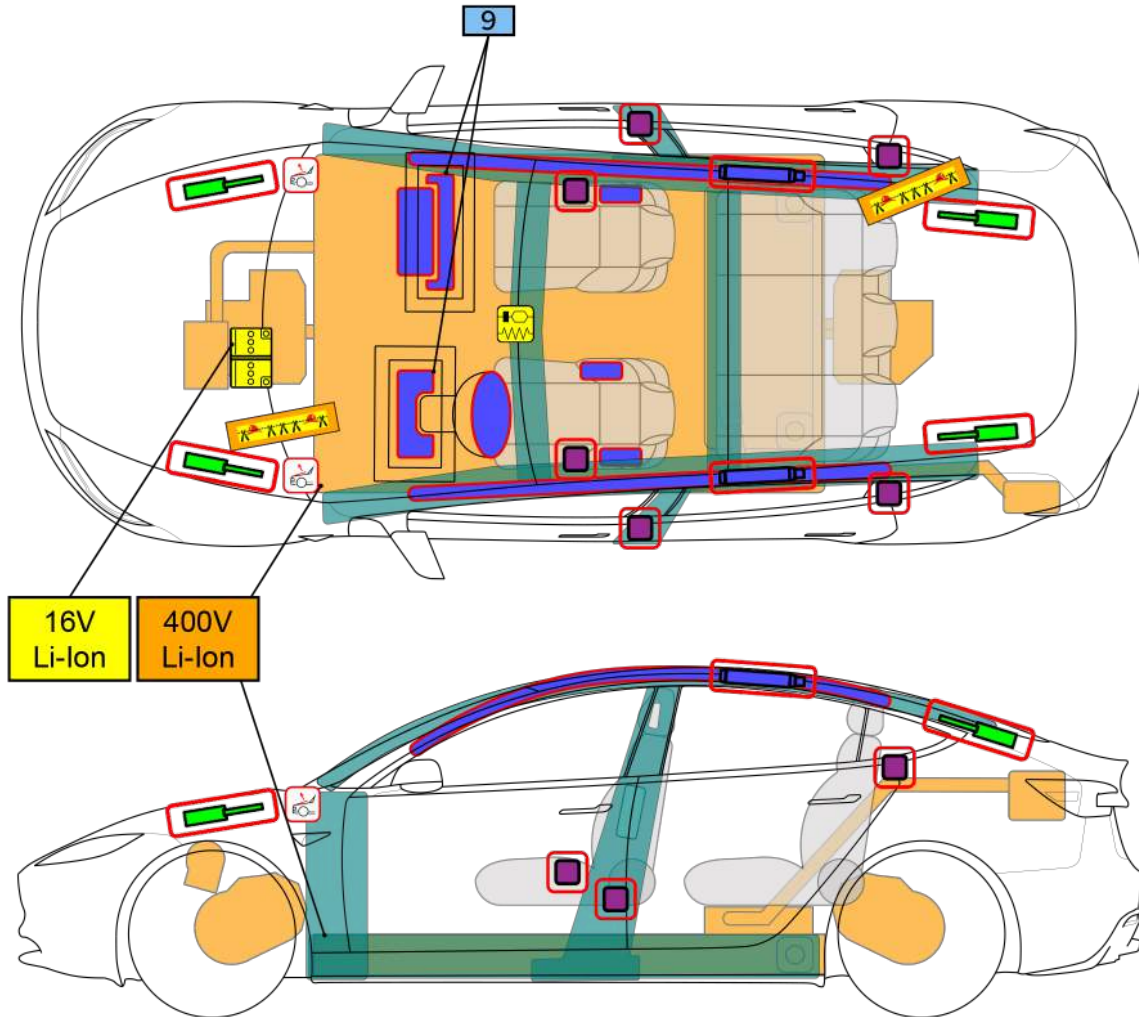
## CONTENTS

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# TESLA MODEL 3

From 2024—Present  
4 doors / 5 seats / sedan



NOTE: Not all features present in all trims.

|  |                                     |  |                            |  |                          |  |                         |  |                              |
|--|-------------------------------------|--|----------------------------|--|--------------------------|--|-------------------------|--|------------------------------|
|  | Airbag                              |  | SRS control unit           |  | Stored gas inflator      |  | Seat belt pre-tensioner |  | Gas strut / Preloaded spring |
|  | Battery low voltage                 |  | Battery pack, high-voltage |  | High voltage power cable |  | Cable cut               |  | High strength zone           |
|  | Pedestrian protection active system |  |                            |  |                          |  |                         |  |                              |

## 1. Identification / recognition



**WARNING** LACK OF ENGINE NOISE DOES NOT MEAN VEHICLE IS OFF: SILENT MOVEMENT OR INSTANT RESTART CAPABILITY EXISTS UNTIL VEHICLE IS FULLY SHUT DOWN. WEAR APPROPRIATE PPE.

### Badging and Door Handles

Model 3 can be identified by its badges and uniquely shaped door handles. The model name does not appear on the rear of the vehicle.

The 2024 Model 3 can also be distinguished from other model years by the shape of the headlights and brake lights and the black finish of the door handles and side cameras.

**NOTE:** Model 3 may have a "DUAL MOTOR" badge or a rectangular space-warp badge on the trunk to indicate that it is a dual motor configuration. The space-warp badge is indicative of a performance vehicle.

**NOTE:** The Tesla emblem indicates a fully electric vehicle.



### Vehicle Identification Number (VIN)

Model 3 can be identified by its VIN. Locate the stamped plate on the top of the dashboard by looking through the driver's side of the windshield. The VIN can also be found on the driver's side door pillar, and on some vehicles, under the carpet behind the passenger seat.

If the touchscreen is operational, you can check the VIN by navigating to **Controls > Software**.



## Touchscreen and Cabin

Model 3 can be identified by the large touchscreen mounted in a “landscape” orientation. Model 3 does not have an instrument cluster in front of the steering wheel.

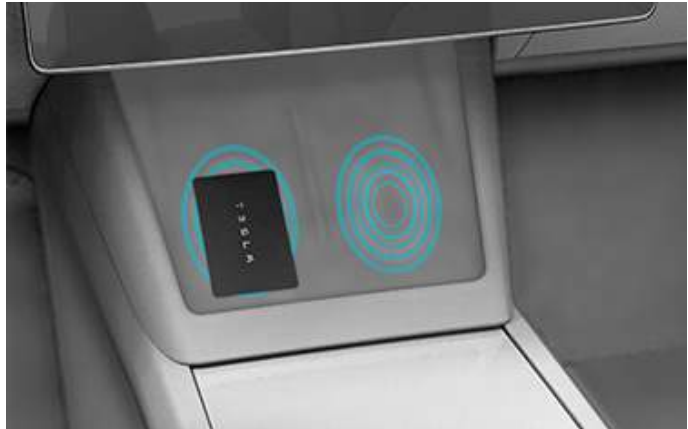


Refer to the Owner’s Manual for information on touchscreen operation. After a collision or if vehicle air-bags have deployed, low voltage power may not be available and the touchscreen will not be operational. Trying to support low voltage power on a vehicle that has been in an accident could lead to a possible electrical fire. We do not recommend attempting to reconnect low voltage power after an accident.

## Keys

Model 3 supports 3 types of keys.

- **Authenticated phone** – A personal smartphone can be set up to communicate with Model 3 using Bluetooth. If a smartphone is already paired to the vehicle, open the Tesla mobile app on the smartphone and navigate to CONTROLS to unlock or lock Model 3.
- **Key card** – Tap the Model 3 key card on the driver's side door pillar to access the locked vehicle. You can also tap the key on the wireless phone charger to enable driving functionality.



- **Key fob** – The key fob is shaped like a miniature Model 3. It allows you to press buttons to open the frunk and rear trunks and unlock, lock, and drive Model 3. Use the key buttons as shown below.



1. Frunk – Double-click to unlatch the frunk.
2. Lock/Unlock All – Single-click to lock doors and trunks (all doors and trunks must be closed). Double-click to unlock doors and trunks.
3. Rear trunk – Double-click to open or close the rear trunk. Hold down for one to two seconds to open the charge port door.

## 2. Immobilization / stabilization / lifting

### IMMOBILIZATION

#### 1. Chock wheels

Model 3 moves quietly, so never assume it is powered off. Model 3 may not move unless the accelerator pedal is pressed, even if shifted into Drive or Reverse. However, never assume that Model 3 will not move. Always chock the wheels.



#### 2. Put vehicle into Park position

Pressing the accelerator pedal even slightly can cause Model 3 to accelerate quickly if the active gear is Drive or Reverse. To ensure that the parking brake is engaged, press and hold the Park (P) button on the touchscreen to shift into Park and enable the parking brake. You can also press and hold Park (P) on the drive mode selector on the overhead console. Whenever Model 3 is in Park, the parking brake is automatically engaged and the touchscreen shows the active gear as Park (P).





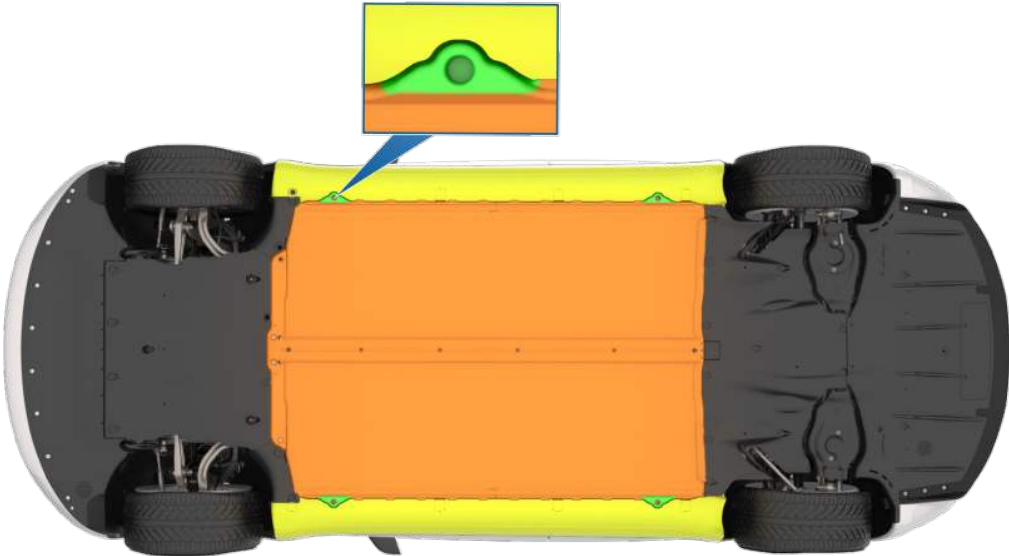
STABILIZATION / LIFTING POINTS

The high voltage battery is located under the floor pan. A large section of the undercarriage houses the high voltage battery. When lifting or stabilizing Model 3, only use the designated lift areas, as shown in green.

 **WARNING** Be careful to not damage the battery pack while stabilizing / lifting the vehicle.

 **WARNING** The vehicle should be lifted or manipulated only if first responders are trained and equipped at the technician level per National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) and are familiar with the vehicle's lifting points. Use caution to ensure you never come into contact with the high voltage battery or other high voltage components while lifting or manipulating the vehicle.

 **WARNING** DO NOT USE THE HIGH VOLTAGE BATTERY TO LIFT OR STABILIZE MODEL 3.



|                                                                                     |                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Appropriate lift areas                                      |
|  | Safe stabilization points for a Model 3 resting on its side |
|  | High voltage battery                                        |



### 3. Disable direct hazards / safety regulations

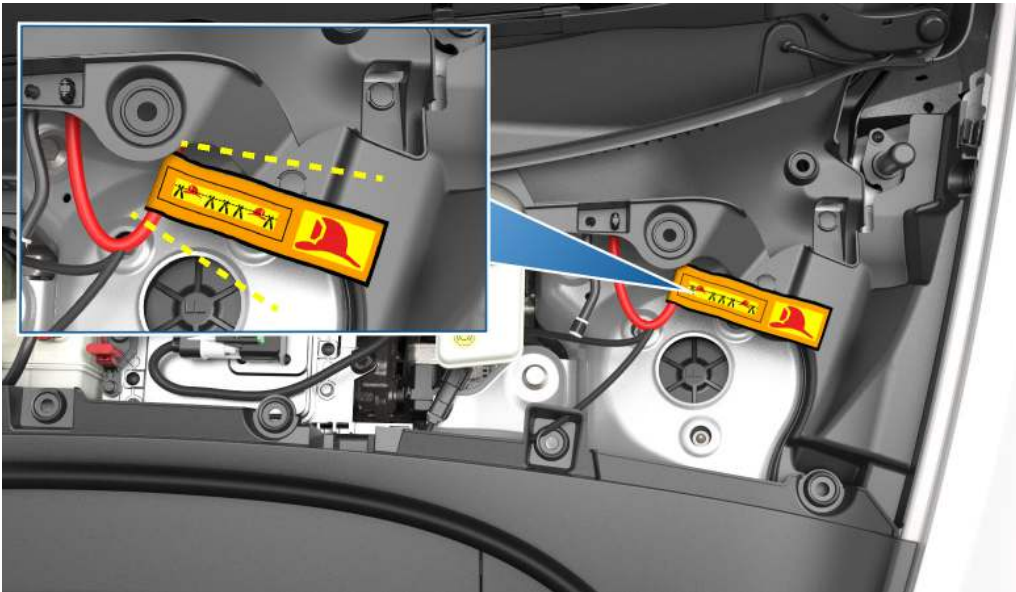
#### ACCESS

1. Open the hood (see chapter 4: Access to the Occupants).
2. Remove the access panel by pulling it upward to release the clips that hold it in place.



#### MAIN DISABLING METHOD

1. Double cut the first responder loop and then remove the cut section.



**WARNING** Not every high voltage component is labeled. Always wear appropriate PPE. Always double cut the first responder loop. Do not attempt to open the High Voltage (HV) battery.



## ALTERNATIVE DISABLING METHOD

1. Break the fixed back window on the right side of the Model 3.
2. Remove the trim covering the internal wiring.
3. Double cut the first responder loop and then remove the cut section.



## COMPLETE DE-POWER

A complete de-power of the vehicle cuts power to the low voltage system and high voltage systems. A de-power disables all electrical systems, as well as basic vehicle functionality such as moving seats and interacting with the touchscreen. Note also that cutting the cables of the low voltage battery alone doesn't necessarily disable the low voltage system due to system redundancies. You must cut the First Responder Loop as well to ensure that the vehicle is de-powered.

1. Access the First Responder Loop under the hood or behind the rear quarter side window.
2. Double cut the First Responder Loop and then remove the cut section.
3. Double cut the negative cables to the low voltage battery.
4. Wait 2 minutes for the vehicle to finish de-powering.



**WARNING** Regardless of the disabling procedure you use, ALWAYS ASSUME THAT ALL HIGH VOLTAGE COMPONENTS ARE ENERGIZED! Cutting, crushing, or touching high voltage components can result in serious injury or death.



**WARNING** When using the high voltage shut down methods recommended by this document, high voltage power is isolated to the battery. The high voltage battery is always energized.



## First Responder Loop Cable Cut

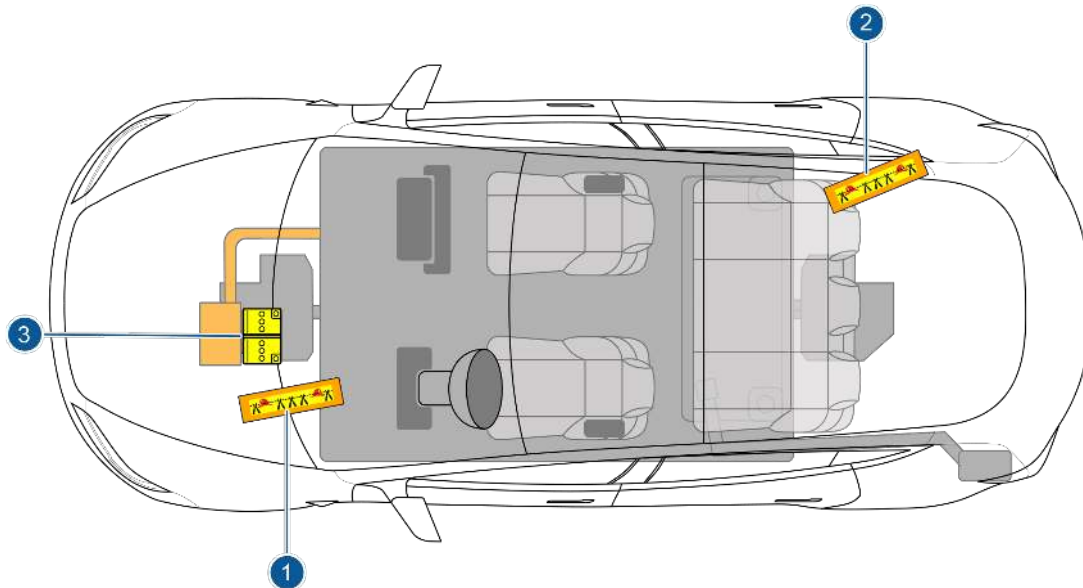
When cut, the First Responder Loop disables low voltage power going to the airbag circuit. Cutting of the First Responder Loop also removes low voltage power going to the high voltage contactors inside the high voltage battery pack, setting the high voltage contactors to "off," or "open." Cutting the low voltage battery cable may not disable all of the low voltage system, and it could disable the use of vehicle immobilization controls, seat controls, touch screen information, and other features.

The primary First Responder Loop is located on the passenger-side of the vehicle for left-hand drive vehicles and is in the same location for right-hand drive vehicles. There is a secondary First Responder Loop behind the rear right-passenger seat.

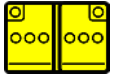
The high voltage contactors disconnect the High Voltage Battery from the rest of the high voltage components, like a light switch. When "open" or in the "off" position, high voltage is present only in the battery pack. When "closed" or in the "on" position, battery pack voltage is connected to the other high voltage components. On Model 3 vehicles, those high voltage components include the rear drive unit, the front drive unit, the air conditioning compressor, and potentially the charge port. When you cut the First Responder Loop, the high voltage contactors open to isolate the high voltage to the battery pack.

When the vehicle has been in an accident and the First Responder Loop has been cut, always treat the pack and the high voltage components as if they are live, because the pack will still have stored energy within the cells and it is not known if other high voltage components have been damaged. Treat every orange cable and battery pack as if there is high voltage in them. Never cut an orange high voltage cable or cut into the battery pack.

There is no way to instantaneously discharge the energy that is inside of the battery pack when a vehicle is in an accident. There is stored energy in battery cells. Caution must be used to not damage the battery pack in the case of vehicle extrication operations.



1. Primary First Responder Cut Loop
2. Secondary First Responder Cut Loop
3. 16V Low Voltage Battery



## Access to Low Voltage Battery

When the vehicle's hood is opened, the low voltage battery is accessible underneath the access panel next to the windshield. When necessary, the negative battery cable should be double cut to open the low voltage battery circuit. Care should always be taken to not cut both the positive and negative battery cables at the same time when double cutting the negative battery cable. Cutting both cables simultaneously can short circuit the low voltage battery.



## Disabling a Charging Vehicle

Before attempting to disable the vehicle, unplug the charging cable. If you have access to the cabin, touch **Controls > Charging > Unlock Charge port** on the touchscreen. You can also hold down the button on the charging cable of Tesla chargers if the car is unlocked or a paired key is nearby to unplug the cable without accessing the vehicle cabin.

If the car cannot be unplugged due to a damaged or locked charging cable, turn off power to the charging station. Then, proceed with disabling procedures by double cutting the First Responder Loop.



**WARNING** Do not cut the charging cable while the charging station has power. Cutting the charging cable while there is still power can start an electrical fire or cause severe injury.

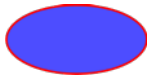
## Manually Release Charging Cable

If you cannot unplug the charging cable and cannot disable the charging station, you can attempt to manually release the charging cable instead of cutting it.

1. Access the rear trunk.
2. Pull the charge port release cable downwards to unlatch the charger cable.
3. Pull the charger cable from the charge port.



**WARNING** Do not pull the release cable while simultaneously attempting to remove the charge cable from the charge port. Always pull the release cable before attempting to remove the charge cable. Failure to follow these instructions can result in electric shock and serious injury.



## Airbags

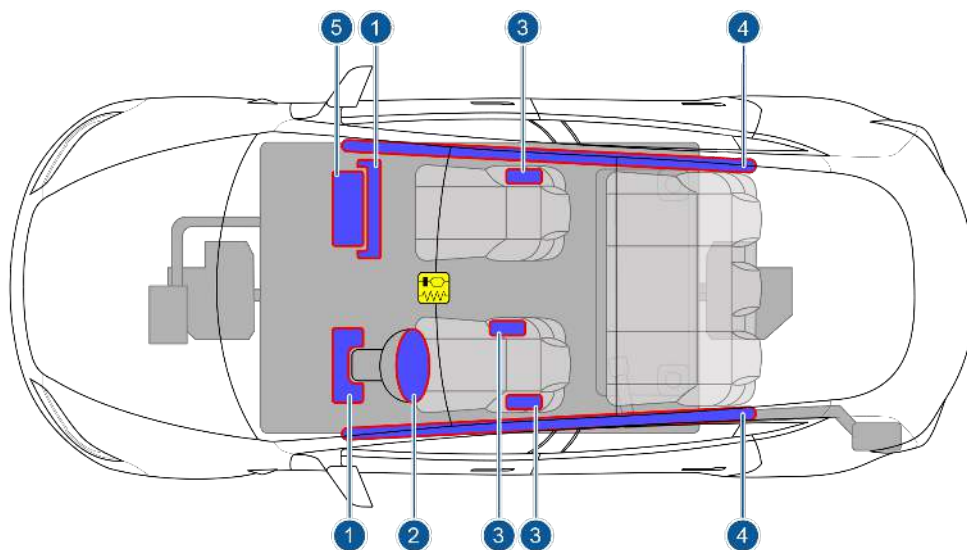
Airbags are located in the approximate areas shown. Airbag warning information is printed on the sun visors.

When the airbags have been deployed by the Restraint Control Module (RCM), the pyrotechnic fuse that deactivates the vehicle's high voltage system will be simultaneously triggered.

Model 3 is designed to deactivate high voltage in all components and cables outside of the high voltage battery when an airbag is deployed. Care must be taken as to not cut any orange high voltage cables or try to gain access into the battery pack. Even though the high voltage system has shut down due to the airbags being deployed, it must always be assumed that there may be high voltage present in the high voltage cables and components. The battery cells within the battery pack will have stored energy and should not be compromised with rescue tools.

The First Responder Loop should be cut in order to open the low voltage circuit that provides power to the airbags. See the First Responder Loop section for more details.

**NOTE:** Left Hand Drive, North American vehicle shown. On Right Hand Drive vehicles, the components are mirrored.



1. Knee airbags
2. Steering wheel airbag
3. Seat mounted side airbags
4. Curtain airbags
5. Passenger airbag



**WARNING** The RCM also has an internal energy reserve which allows it to remain powered for 10 seconds after both high voltage and low voltage power are disconnected. Do not touch the RCM within this 10 second time frame.

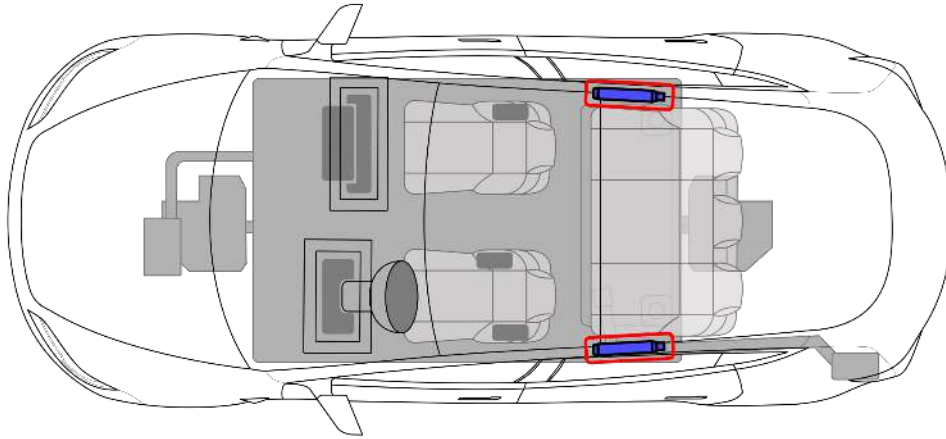


Knee airbags are only installed in North America and Taiwan.



### Stored Gas Inflators

The stored gas inflators, outlined in red, are located near the roof and towards the rear of the vehicle.



**WARNING** Rescuers should never cut or crush inflation cylinders. Cutting or compressing cylinders causes catastrophic failure, leading to injury or death.

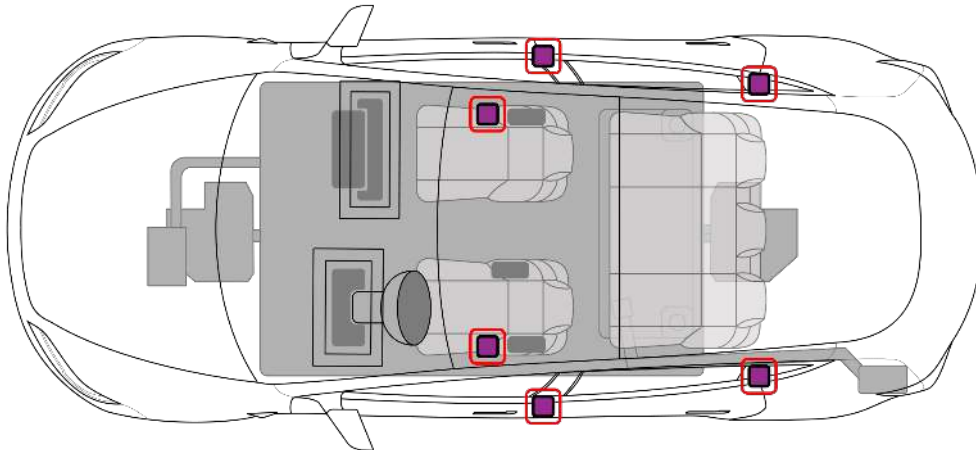


**WARNING** The RCM has a backup power supply with a discharge time of approximately 10 seconds. Do not touch the RCM within 10 seconds of an airbag or pre-tensioner deployment.



### Seatbelt Pre-Tensioners

The seat belt pre-tensioners, outlined in red, are located at the bottom and top of the B-pillars. There are additional seat belt pre-tensioners located outboard of the 2nd row seats.







## Active Hood

The Active Hood pedestrian protection system is a safety feature that can detect an impact with a pedestrian while the vehicle is moving between approximately 30 and 52 km/hr (18 and 32 mph). When triggered, pyrotechnic actuators raise the rear portion of the hood to increase the space between the hood and the components beneath it.



If the vehicle is equipped with Active Hood, the pyrotechnic actuators are located under the hood towards the base of the windshield.

Note: The pyrotechnic actuators can also deploy when colliding with an animal, vehicle or other object.

Notes: Active Hood may not be installed in every market or configuration.



**WARNING** Rescuers should never cut or crush the pyrotechnic actuators. Cutting or compressing actuators can cause catastrophic failure, leading to injury or death.

## 4. Access to the occupants

**NOTE:** The seats, steering wheel, and interior door buttons are electrically powered and may not function after a collision.

**NOTE:** After a collision, the doors and trunk may not unlock from the outside. Severe collisions may cause doors to be mechanically difficult to operate. Extrication may be required.

### Opening Doors from the Outside with Power

To open the Model 3 doors from the outside, press the wide part of a door handle inwards and then pull the door open.

**NOTE:** If the door handles do not function, open a front door manually by reaching inside the window and using the mechanical release handle. See Opening Front Doors from Inside without Power.



### Opening Doors from Inside with Power

To open the Model 3 doors from the inside with low voltage power available, press the button located near the door panel.



## Opening Front Doors from Inside without Power

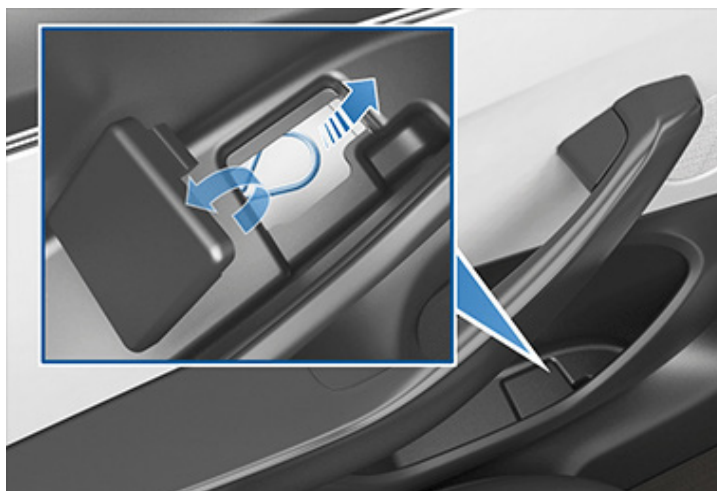
To open the Model 3 front doors from the inside without low voltage power, lift the mechanical release handle located near the window switches.



## Opening Rear Doors from Inside without Power

To open the Model 3 rear doors from the inside without low voltage power:

1. At the bottom of the rear door pocket, there is a slot in front of the release cover. Slide your finger into the slot to remove the cover.
2. Pull the mechanical release cable forward.



Manual door releases are designed to be used only in situations when the vehicle has no power. It is important to know also that in any vehicle collision with damage to the driver or passenger front door, the mechanical door release may not operate as designed. Remember also that every vehicle accident is different and extrication operations may be required to gain access to the vehicle cabin.



## Opening the Trunk with Low Voltage Power

Use one of the following methods to open the trunk:

1. Touch the associated OPEN button on the touchscreen for the trunk.
2. Press the switch located under the exterior handle on the trunk.





## Moving the Front Seats with Power

Model 3 has electrically powered seats that move with buttons located on the side of the seat closest to the door. The buttons operate only when low voltage power is enabled and can still be used after the First Responder Loop is cut if the low voltage system is intact.



1. Moves seat forward/backward and adjust the seat's height and tilt angle up/down.
2. Adjusts backrest.
3. Adjusts lumbar support.



## Opening the Hood with Power

Model 3 does not have a traditional internal combustion engine. Therefore, the area that would normally house the engine is used as additional storage space. Tesla calls this area the "Front Trunk" or "Frunk".

To open the hood with low voltage power enabled, touch the associated OPEN button on the touchscreen.



## Opening the Hood Using an External Low Voltage Power Supply

If low voltage power is not available, you might need an external power supply to access the hood and cut the first responder loop. This method will not open the front trunk if Model 3 is locked and has low voltage power. Use an external power supply, such as a jumper box, for the following:

1. Release the tow eye cover by pressing firmly on the top right perimeter of the cover until it pivots inward, then pulling the raised section toward you.



2. Pull the two wires out of the tow eye opening to expose the vehicle-side terminals.
3. Connect the external low voltage power supply's red positive (+) cable to the red positive (+) vehicle-side terminal.
4. Connect the external low voltage power supply's black negative (-) cable to the black negative (-) vehicle-side terminal.

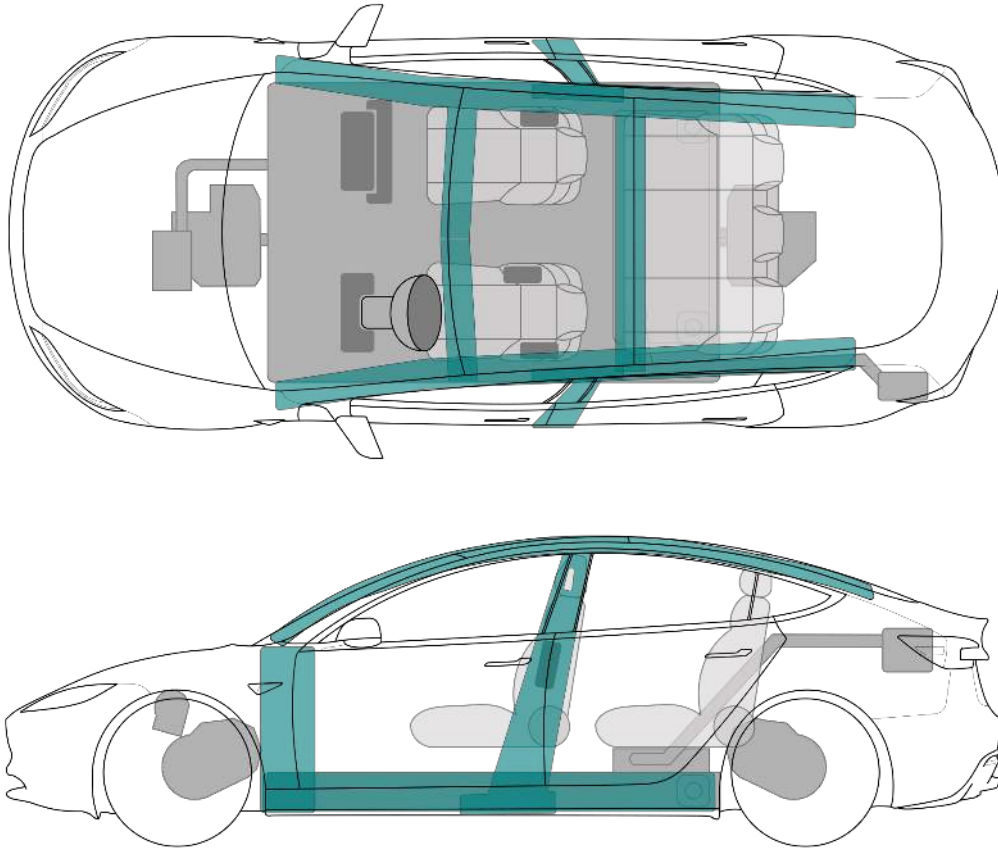


5. Turn on the external power supply (refer to the manufacturer's instructions of your external power supply). The hood latches are immediately released and you can open the hood to access the frunk area.
6. Disconnect both external power supply cables, beginning with the black negative (-) cable.



## High Strength Zone

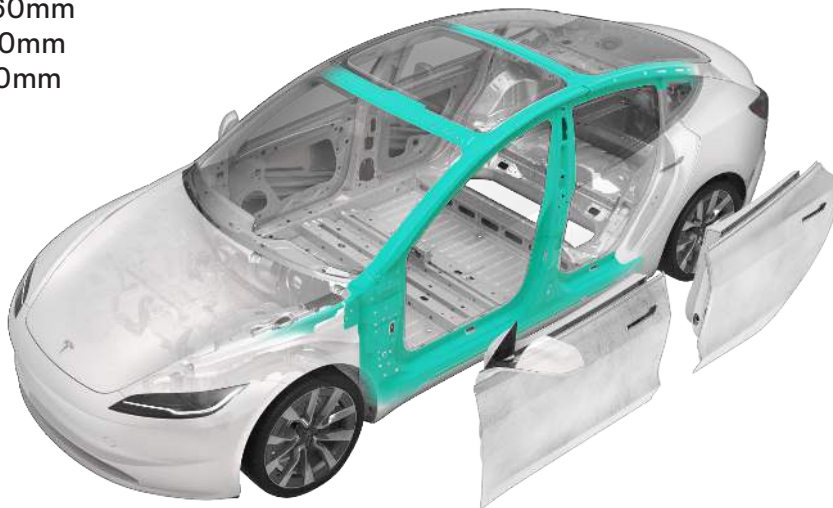
Model 3 is reinforced to protect occupants in a collision. Suitable tools must be used to cut or crush these areas. Reinforcements are shown in teal below.



The A and B pillars, front door rings, and overhead rails of Model 3 are constructed of ultra-high-strength reinforced steel. The vehicle's doors are made of aluminum. All other structural body components are made up of various strengths of steel or aluminum.

Maximum thickness of high strength steel:

1. Outer door ring: 1.60mm
2. Inner door ring: 1.60mm
3. Overhead rails: 1.40mm







**WARNING** Always use appropriate tools, such as a hydraulic cutter, and always wear appropriate PPE when cutting Model 3. Failure to follow these instructions can result in serious injury or death.

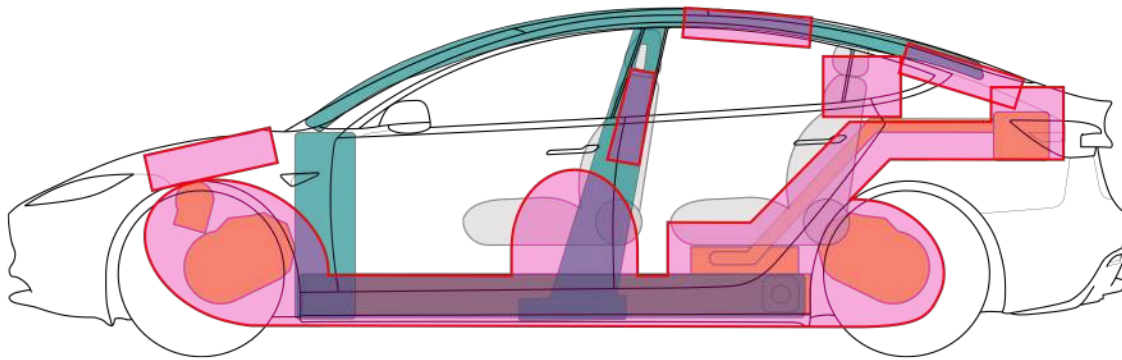


**WARNING** Regardless of the disabling procedure you use, ALWAYS ASSUME THAT ALL HIGH VOLTAGE COMPONENTS ARE ENERGIZED! Cutting, crushing, or touching high voltage components can result in serious injury or death.

## No-Cut Zones

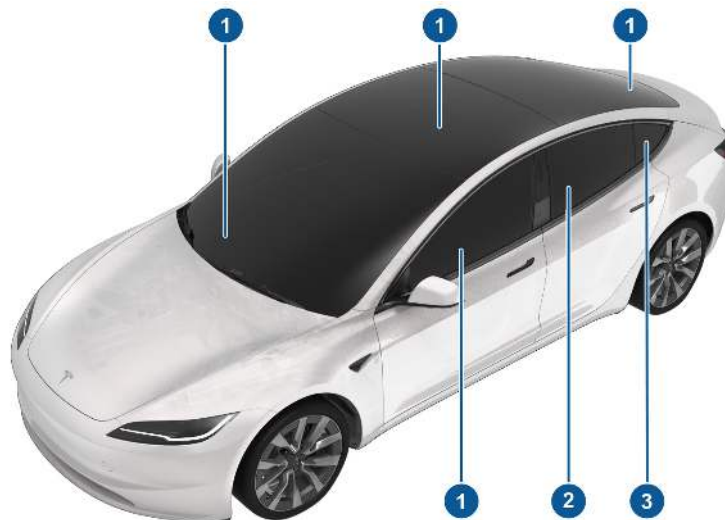
Model 3 has areas that are defined as “no-cut zones” due to the presence of high voltage, gas struts, SRS components, or other hazards. Never cut or crush in these areas. Doing so could result in serious injury or death. The “no-cut zones” are shown in pink.

**NOTE:** The following image shows a Dual Motor vehicle. Vehicles without a front drive unit are similar.



## Windows

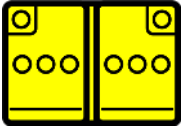
The windshield, roof, front doors, and rear trunk glass on Model 3 are made of laminated safety glass. The rear side windows can be either tempered or laminated glass. The fixed rear quarter side windows are made of tempered safety glass



1. Laminated safety glass
2. Tempered or laminated safety glass
3. Tempered safety glass

**NOTE:** Cutting laminated safety glass can create a lot of glass dust. Consider additional respiratory PPE for both crew and passengers when cutting laminated windows.

## 5. Stored energy / liquids / gases / solids

|                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 16V  |
|  |       | 400V |

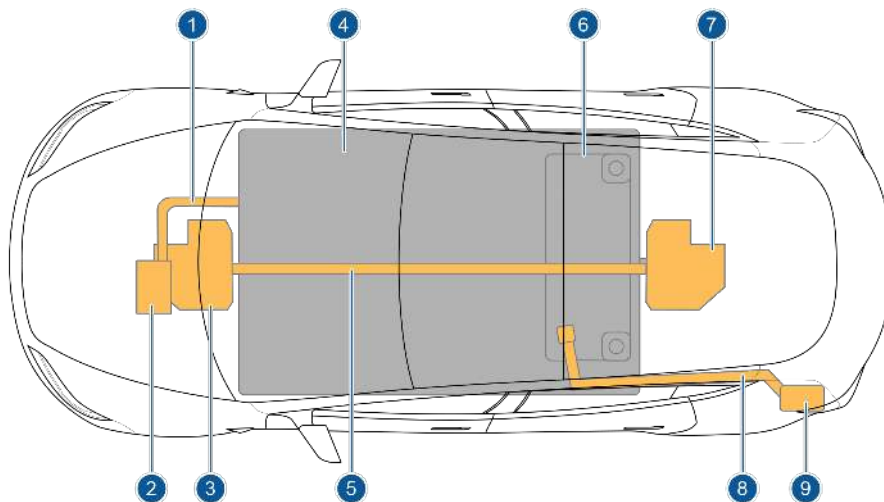


**WARNING** Clear liquid is likely water. Battery electrolyte is clear, but battery cells are sealed and have a limited volume of electrolyte per cell. The coolant is blue.

**NOTE:** The following images show a Dual Motor vehicle. Vehicles without a front drive unit are similar.



### High Voltage Components

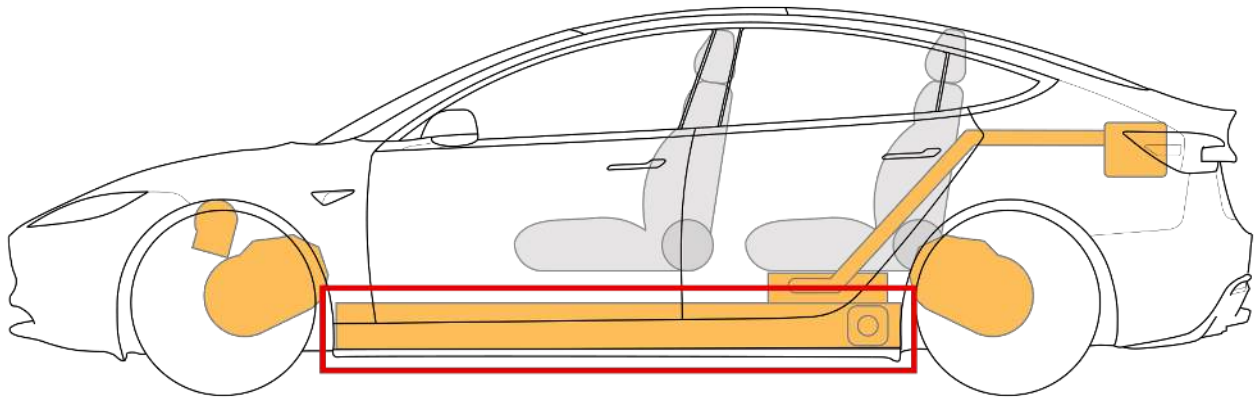


1. High Voltage Cabling
2. Air Conditioning Compressor
3. Front Motor (Dual Motor vehicles only)
4. High Voltage Battery
5. High Voltage Cabling
6. High Voltage Battery Service Panel
7. Rear Motor
8. High Voltage Busbars and Cables
9. Charge Port



## High Voltage Battery Pack

Model 3 is equipped with a floor-mounted 400V lithium-ion high voltage battery. The battery is made up of many cells that are liquid cooled with coolant. The coolant will appear blue in color and may leak from the battery pack if the pack has been compromised during a vehicle collision. The battery cells will have stored energy within them. Never breach the high voltage battery when lifting from under the vehicle. When using rescue tools, pay special attention to ensure that you do not breach the floor pan. Refer to Chapter 2: Lift Areas for instructions on how to properly lift the vehicle.



## Pushing on the Floor Pan

The high voltage battery is located below the floor pan. At no time should the high voltage battery pack be compromised with rescue tools.

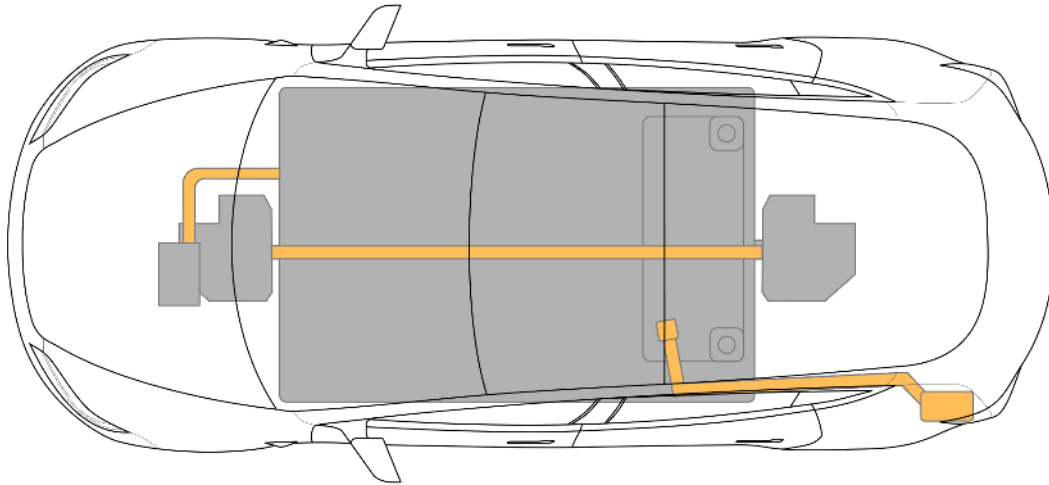


**WARNING** Never push on the floor pan itself inside of Model 3. Doing so can breach the high voltage battery or damage the high voltage cables, which can cause serious injury or death.



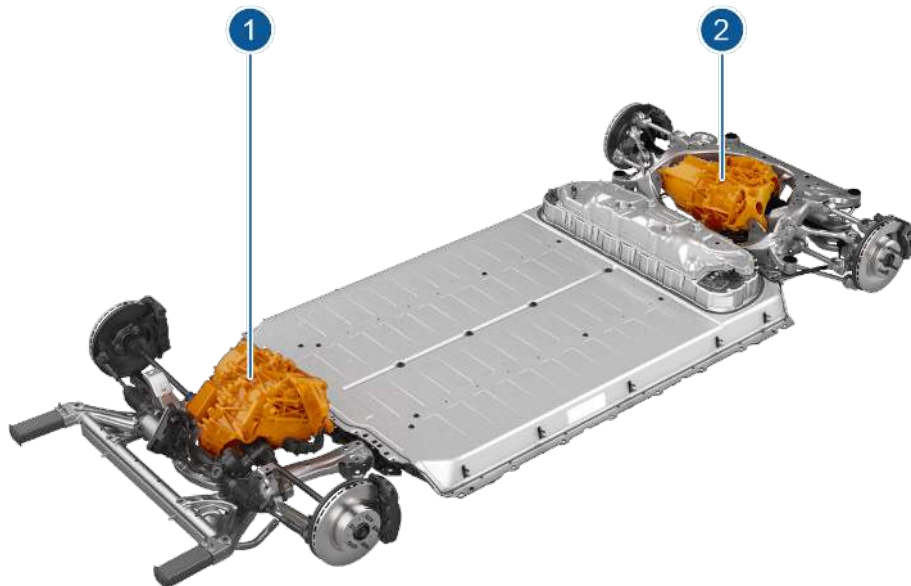
## High Voltage Power Cable / Busbar / Component

High voltage cables and busbars are shown in orange. There are high voltage cables and busbars that run the length of the battery pack on the bottom side through an extrusion providing protection. Do not compromise these high voltage components with rescue tools. The assumption should be made that there may be high voltage present in the Orange High Voltage Cables at all times.

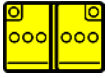


## Drive Units

The rear drive unit is located between the rear wheels, and the front drive unit (if equipped- Dual Motor vehicles only) is located between the front wheels. The drive inverter is located within the drive unit. The drive units convert Direct Current (DC) from the high voltage battery into Alternating Current (AC) that the drive units use to power the wheels.

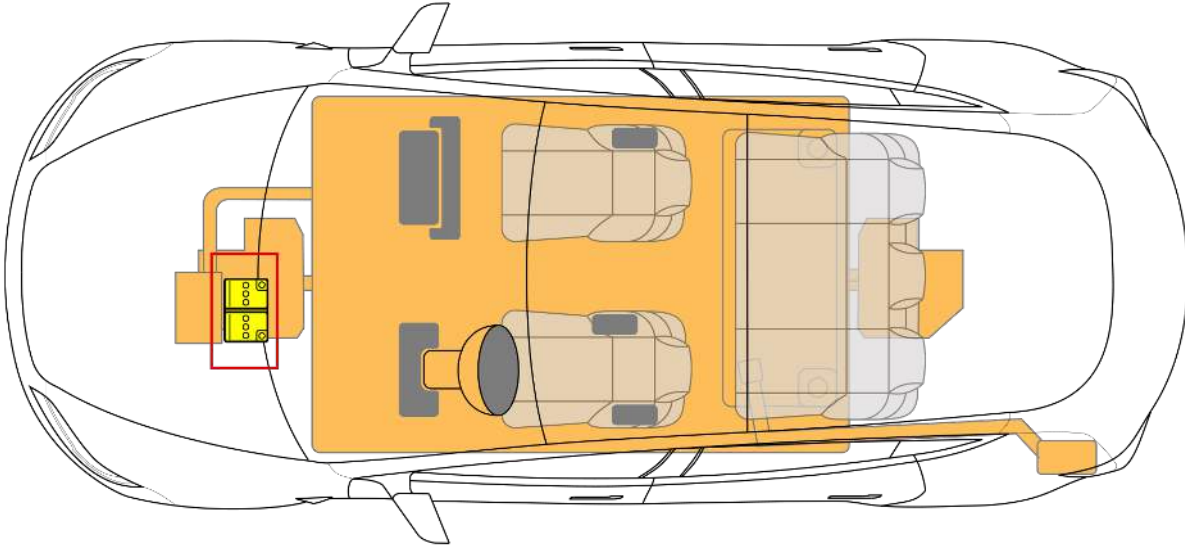


1. Front Drive Unit
2. Rear Drive Unit

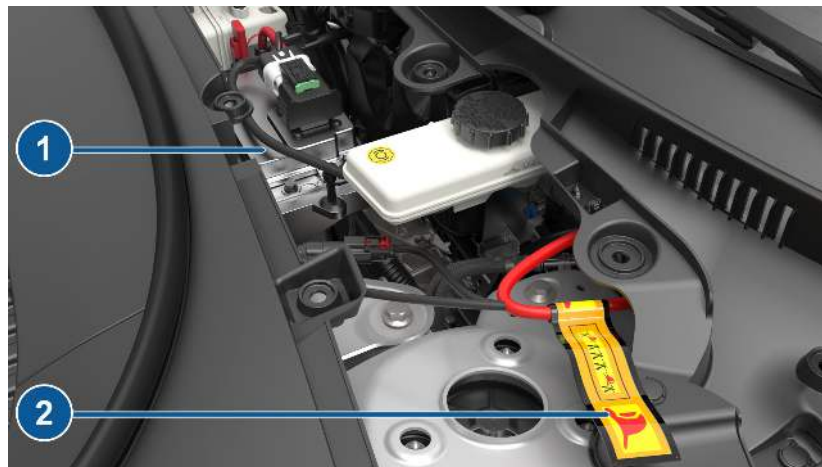


## Low Voltage Battery Pack

In addition to the high voltage system, Model 3 has a low voltage electrical system. The battery of the low voltage system is charged by the high voltage system. The low voltage battery operates the restraint system, seats, airbags, windows, door locks, touchscreen, and interior and exterior lights. The low voltage battery, outlined in red, is located under the hood and the plastic access panel.



**WARNING** Cutting the low voltage battery cables doesn't always disable the low voltage system. Model 3 is designed with redundancies that use the high voltage system to power the low voltage system.



1. Low Voltage Battery
2. First Responder Cut Loop

## 6. In case of fire

### Firefighting



 **DO NOT SUBMERGE VEHICLE TO EXTINGUISH/COOL BATTERY FIRE**

 **USE LARGE AMOUNTS OF WATER**

 **POSSIBLE BATTERY RE-IGNITION!**

**MONITOR HV BATTERY TEMPERATURE FOR AT LEAST 24 HOURS**



USE WATER TO FIGHT A HIGH VOLTAGE BATTERY FIRE. If the battery catches fire, is exposed to high heat, or is generating heat or gases, use water to cool the battery. It can take between approximately 3,000-8,000 gallons (11,356-30,283 liters) of water, applied directly to the battery, to fully extinguish and cool down a battery fire; always establish or request additional water supply early. If water is not immediately available, use CO<sub>2</sub>, dry chemicals, or another typical fire-extinguishing agent to fight the fire until water is available.

**NOTE:** Tesla does not recommend the use of foam on electric vehicles.

Apply water directly to the battery. If safety permits, lift or tilt the vehicle for more direct access to the battery (see chapter 2). Water may be applied from a safe distance **ONLY** if a natural opening (such as a vent or opening from a collision) already exists. Do not open the battery for the purpose of cooling it.

Tesla does not recommend placing the vehicle in a large container full of water. The use of a Thermal Image Camera or Infrared (TIC or IR) is recommended to monitor battery temperatures during the cooling process. Continue to use water until the battery has reached ambient temperatures or below, indicated by the thermal image camera. When utilizing a thermal imaging camera, allow enough time, once the application of water has stopped, to allow for heat within the battery to transfer to the battery enclosure.

Extinguish small fires that do not involve the high voltage battery using typical vehicle firefighting procedures.

During fire extinguishing, do not make contact with any high voltage components. Always use insulated tools for fire extinguishing.



Heat and flames can compromise airbag inflators, stored gas inflation cylinders, gas struts, and other components which can result in unexpected excessive heat, which can cause inflation cylinder explosion. Perform an adequate knock down before entering a hot zone.





Battery fires can take up to 24 hours to fully cool. After suppression and smoke has visibly subsided, a thermal image camera can be used to actively measure the temperature of the high voltage battery and monitor the trend of heating or cooling. There must be no fire, smoke, audible popping/hissing, or heating present in the high voltage battery for at least 45 minutes before the vehicle can be released to second responders (such as law enforcement, vehicle transporters, etc.). The battery must be completely cooled before releasing the vehicle to second responders or otherwise leaving the incident.

There is always a risk of battery re-ignition. Drain excess water out of the vehicle by tilting or raising the front of the vehicle approximately 30 cm (1 foot). This operation can assist in mitigating possible re-ignition.

Due to potential re-ignition, a Model 3 that has been involved in a submersion, fire, or a collision that has compromised the high voltage battery should be stored in an open area at least 50 feet (15 m) from any exposure.



**WARNING** During all firefighting activities, consider the vehicle energized. Always wear full PPE including a Self-Contained Breathing Apparatus (SCBA).

## High-Voltage Battery — Fire Damage



Similar to conventional and other electric and hybrid vehicles, a burning battery releases super-heated gases and toxic vapors. This release may include volatile organic compounds, hydrogen gas, carbon dioxide, carbon monoxide, soot, particulates containing oxides of nickel, aluminum, lithium, copper, cobalt, and hydrogen fluoride. Responders should always protect themselves with full PPE, including a SCBA, and take appropriate measures to protect civilians downwind from the incident.



A damaged high voltage battery can create rapid heating of the battery cells. If you notice smoke, steam, or audible popping or hissing coming from the high voltage battery, assume that it is heated and take appropriate action as described above.



## 7. In case of submersion

Treat a submerged Model 3 like any other submerged vehicle. The body of Model 3 does not present a greater risk of shock because it is in water. However, handle any submerged vehicle while wearing the appropriate PPE for water rescue. Remove the vehicle from the water and continue normal disabling procedures as outlined in Chapter 3.

Vehicles that are waterlogged or have been submerged in water should be handled with greater caution due to the potential risk of electrical fire. After removing the vehicle from the water and completing disabling procedures, raise the front of the vehicle approximately 30 cm (1 foot) to allow water to drain out of the vehicle and the high voltage battery pack.

Submerged or waterlogged vehicles must be transported and stored more carefully. When loading the vehicle for towing, use a Thermal Image Camera or Infrared (TIC or IR) to monitor battery temperatures and check for potential hot spots and continue monitoring until the vehicle is taken away. Store the vehicle outside at a safe distance at least 50 ft/15 M from other vehicles and structures.



**WARNING** Do not use firefighting foams with vehicles that were submerged or waterlogged with salt water. The use of firefighting foams on vehicles saturated with salt water have a higher risk of electrical fire.

## 8. Towing / transportation / storage

The rear motor in the Model 3 can generate power when the wheels spin. Always transport with all four tires off of the ground. Ensure that the tires are unable to spin at any time during transport.



**WARNING** NEVER TRANSPORT THE VEHICLE WITH THE TIRES IN A POSITION WHERE THEY CAN SPIN. DOING SO CAN LEAD TO SIGNIFICANT DAMAGE AND OVERHEATING. IN RARE CASES EXTREME OVERHEATING MAY CAUSE THE SURROUNDING COMPONENTS TO IGNITE.



**WARNING** POSSIBLE BATTERY RE-IGNITION! AFTER A FIRE INCIDENT, STORE OUTSIDE AT A SAFE DISTANCE (50 FT/15 M) FROM OTHER VEHICLES AND STRUCTURES!



A roll-back truck or comparable transport vehicle is the recommended method of transport. The vehicle can face either direction when using a flatbed. If the vehicle must be transported without a roll-back truck, then wheel lifts and dollies must be used to ensure that all four wheels are off of the ground. This method must not exceed the manufacturer speed rating of the dollies. With this method, Tesla recommends the vehicle faces forward so that the front wheels are lifted and the rear wheels are on dollies.

**NOTE:** The tires are allowed to rotate slowly (under 3 mph or 5 km/h) and for a very short distance (less than 30 feet or 10 meters) only when Tow Mode is enabled while the vehicle is being winched onto a flatbed truck or pulled out of a parking space for repositioning. Exceeding these boundaries can lead to significant damage and overheating that is not covered by the warranty.

**NOTE:** Enable Tow Mode on the vehicle's touchscreen before winching the vehicle onto a flatbed truck. If Tow Mode is not available or the touchscreen is not accessible, self-loading dollies or tire skates must be used to load the vehicle into the approved transportation position. Tesla is not responsible for any damage caused by or during transport of the vehicle, including personal property damage or damage caused by using self-loading dollies or tire skates.



**WARNING** The vehicle is equipped with high voltage components that may be compromised as a result of a collision. Before transporting, it is important to assume these components are energized. Always follow high voltage safety precautions (wearing personal protective equipment, etc.) until emergency response professionals have evaluated the vehicle and can accurately confirm that all high voltage systems are no longer energized. Failure to do so may result in serious injury.

## Pushing the Vehicle



**WARNING** The following instructions are intended to be used when only moving Model 3 a very short distance to improve traffic safety. Refer to the Owner's Manual on the touchscreen for more instructions on how to transport Model 3. Damage caused by transporting the vehicle is not covered by the warranty.



**WARNING** Pushing Model 3 when it is not in Neutral or Tow Mode can result in overheating the rear motor and potential risk of shock if electrical components are exposed, even if the first responder loop has been cut.

In situations where there is minimal risk of fire or high voltage exposure (for example, the vehicle does not accelerate after coming to a stop at an intersection) and low voltage power is present, Model 3 can be quickly pushed in order to clear the roadway. If a driver is present, simply shift Model 3 into Neutral (N) on the touchscreen drive strip and then push the vehicle. If a driver is not present, Model 3 may automatically shift into Park when it detects the driver leaving the vehicle (even if it has previously been shifted into Neutral).

To keep Model 3 in Neutral (which disengages the parking brake and allows the vehicle to be pushed) without a driver present, use the touchscreen to activate Tow Mode:

1. Ensure Model 3 is in Park by long pressing Park (P) on the touchscreen drive strip or the overhead console.
2. Press and hold the brake pedal, then on the touchscreen touch **Controls > Service > Towing**.
3. Touch the Enter Tow Mode button until it turns blue. Model 3 is now free-rolling and can slowly be rolled (no faster than walking speed) or winched.

To cancel Tow Mode, shift Model 3 into Park.

**NOTE:** Model 3 must detect a key nearby and low voltage power is required for Tow Mode to activate.

**NOTE:** Tow Mode automatically cancels and the parking brake is applied if Model 3 is rolled faster than 5 mph (8 km/h) or low voltage power becomes low or absent. Model 3 sounds its horn if Tow Mode is about to cancel.

**NOTE:** If Model 3 cannot detect the key (an authenticated smartphone or key), the Tow Mode button is grayed out and Tow Mode cannot be enabled. Call Tesla Roadside Assistance.

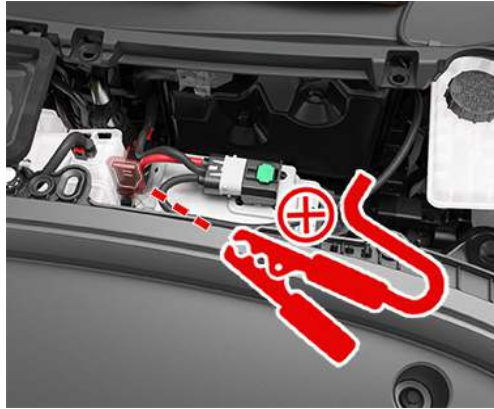
**NOTE:** The touchscreen is unresponsive if Model 3 has no low voltage power. Use an external low voltage power supply to open the hood and jump start the vehicle's auxiliary low voltage battery. See the Owner's Manual or call Tesla Roadside Assistance for instructions.

**NOTE:** If airbags are deployed, you cannot drive Robotaxi. Do not push or move the vehicle unless you can enable Tow Mode. Otherwise, you must first secure the wheels for transport.

## Jump Starting the Vehicle

In situations where there is minimal risk of fire or high voltage exposure and low voltage power is not present, you can jump-start the vehicle using an external power supply. To jump start the vehicle:

1. Open the hood to access the front trunk area (see Chapter 4: Access to the Occupants).
2. Remove the maintenance panel by pulling it upwards to release the trim clips that hold it in place.
3. Remove the red cover and connect the external low voltage power supply's red positive (+) cable to the red positive (+) jump post.



4. Connect the external low voltage power supply's black negative (-) cable to the bolt located next to the brake fluid reservoir. The bolt is used as a grounding location for the external support.



5. Turn on the external power supply (refer to the manufacturer's instructions). Touch the vehicle touch-screen to wake it up. This may take several minutes.
6. Switch off or disconnect the power supply when low voltage power is no longer needed.
7. Disconnect the cables, beginning with the black negative cable.

## 9. Important additional information

This document contains important instructions and warnings that must be followed when handling Model 3 in an emergency situation.

**NOTE:** Images in this document show a Left-Hand Drive (LHD), North American vehicle. Unless otherwise noted, Right-Hand Drive (RHD) vehicles are **not** mirrored.

**NOTE:** Model 3 is equipped with knee airbags in North America and Taiwan only.



**WARNING** Always use appropriate rescue tools and always wear appropriate PPE. Failure to follow these instructions can result in serious injury or death.



**WARNING** Regardless of the disabling procedure you use, ALWAYS ASSUME THAT ALL HIGH VOLTAGE COMPONENTS ARE ENERGIZED! Cutting, crushing, or touching high voltage components can result in serious injury or death.



**WARNING** After deactivation, the high voltage circuit requires 2 minutes to de-energize.



**WARNING** The RCM has a backup power supply with a discharge time of approximately 10 seconds. Do not touch the RCM within 10 seconds of airbag or pre-tensioner deployment.



**WARNING** Handling a submerged vehicle without appropriate PPE for water rescue can result in serious injury or death.



**WARNING** When fire is involved, consider the entire vehicle energized. Always wear full PPE, including a SCBA.



**WARNING** When cutting the first responder loop, double cut the loop to remove an entire section. This mitigates the risk of the cut wires accidentally reconnecting.



**WARNING** When using the high voltage shut down methods recommended by this document, high voltage power is isolated to the battery. The high voltage battery is always energized.



**WARNING** Never transport the Model 3 with rear wheels on the ground. Doing so can lead to significant damage and overheating. In rare cases, extreme overheating may cause the surrounding components to ignite.

## Contact Us

First Responders and Second Responders with emergencies, call Tesla Roadside Assistance. Refer to <https://www.tesla.com/support/roadside-assistance> for the applicable number.

Refer to <https://www.tesla.com/firstresponders> for the Owner's Manual and first responder information. First responders and training officers with questions, contact [firstrespondersafety@tesla.com](mailto:firstrespondersafety@tesla.com).

## 10. Explanation pictograms used

|                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    | In some working environments, the Infrared (IR) device is referred to as a Thermal Imaging Camera (TIC).                        |
|    | Refers to the hood of a vehicle and follows with detailed procedure for opening the hood both with and without power available. |
|    | Refers to the trunk of a vehicle and follows with detailed procedure for opening the trunk with power.                          |
|    | Electricity warning                                                                                                             |
|    | Flammable                                                                                                                       |
|    | Explosive                                                                                                                       |
|   | Corrosive substances present                                                                                                    |
|  | Hazardous to human health                                                                                                       |
|  | Acute toxicity                                                                                                                  |
|  | Contains gases under pressure                                                                                                   |
|  | Use water to extinguish                                                                                                         |